

Main Topic and Key Details

USA Grade 2 ELA
CCSS RI.2.1-RI.2.2

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING TARGET

I can identify the main topic of a multi-paragraph informational text and explain key details.

KEY STRATEGY + WORKED EXAMPLE

Ask what the whole text is mostly about. Then select details that teach about that topic.

If every paragraph explains bees' jobs, the main topic is how bees help a hive.

A. TRY TOGETHER - USE THE STRATEGY

1. Main topic means whole text / one tiny fact
2. Key detail supports topic: yes/no
3. A heading can signal topic: yes/no
4. A question should be answered from text: yes/no

B. CORE PRACTICE - READ AND WRITE

5. Text: Beavers build dams in streams.

7. A dam slows water and creates a pond.

9. Main topic = ____

11. Effect of dam = ____

6. They use branches, mud, and stones.

8. The pond gives beavers a safer home.

10. Material detail = ____

12. Why pond matters = ____

C. INDEPENDENT PRACTICE - APPLY THE PATTERN

13. Who builds dams?

15. Name two materials.

17. What forms behind dam?

19. One key detail = ____

14. Where are dams built?

16. What happens to water?

18. Best heading = ____

20. One question for the text = ____

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D. APPLY THE SKILL IN CONTEXT

21. Explain the main topic in one complete sentence.

22. List three key details in your own words.

23. Write a short summary without adding an unsupported fact.

E. EXPLAIN, CHECK AND EDIT

24. Why is 'beavers use stones' a detail rather than the main topic?

25. Which detail explains cause and effect? Explain.

EXIT TICKET + CHALLENGE

26. Write the main topic and two supporting details.

Challenge: Add one factual paragraph that stays focused on the topic; mark any research needed.

F. STUDENT REVIEW - SHOW WHAT YOU UNDERSTAND

Use your own words so your teacher can see what you understand and what to practise next.

27. Explain one strategy you used today.

28. Check one answer in a different way.

29. Circle one: I understand it | I need more practice | I need help

30. The easiest part was: _____

31. The most difficult part was: _____

Why was it difficult? _____

32. My next practice step is: _____

TEACHER COPY - ANSWERS AND SUPPORT

ANSWER KEY

A. 1) whole text. 2-4) yes.

B. 5-8) text lines. 9) beaver dams. 10) branches/mud/stones. 11) slows water/creates pond. 12) safer home.

C. 13) beavers. 14) streams. 15) any two listed. 16) it slows. 17) pond. 18) How Beavers Build Helpful Dams. 19-20) Answers vary.

D. 21) Beavers build dams that change streams and create safer homes. 22) Any three accurate details. 23) Answers vary, text-based.

E. 24) It is one fact supporting the broader topic. 25) Dam slows water and creates pond.

EXIT. 26) Main topic plus two accurate details.

Challenge: Answers vary. Check that the student's example follows every condition and that the reasoning is mathematically correct.

F. 27-28) Answers vary. Look for a clear strategy and a valid second check. 29-32) Use the reflection to identify confidence, difficulty and the next teaching step.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Students may choose the most interesting detail as the main topic. Test whether the topic covers every paragraph or sentence.

TEACHER CHECK

☐ Uses an appropriate Grade 1 strategy.

☐ Shows or explains thinking clearly.

☐ Checks an answer using a second representation or related fact.

☐ Identifies a specific difficulty and useful next practice step.

PARENT / TEACHER TIP

Ask the child to explain how they know, not only state an answer. If the explanation is unclear, use small objects, a drawing, or a number line before returning to symbols.

NEXT STEP

Revisit the item the child marked difficult. Model one example, solve one together, then ask the child to complete one independently and explain the strategy.